

Some wireless carriers had assumed a “build it and they will come” strategy, meaning that they would just provide the transport of data as well as the terminals, and then wait for content providers to publish their services on the Internet and make their investment in WAP useful. However, content providers received little help or incentive to go through the complicated route of development. Others, notably in Japan, had a more thorough dialogue with their content provider community, which was then replicated in modern, more successful WAP services such as i-mode in Europe or the Gallery service in France.

Most wireless carriers sold their WAP services that were “open,” in that they allowed users to reach any service expressed in WML and published on the Internet. However, they also made sure that the first page that clients accessed was their own “wireless portal,” which they controlled very closely. Given the difficulty in typing up fully qualified URLs on a phone keyboard, most users would give up going “off portal”; by not letting third parties put their own entries on the operators’ wireless portal, some contend that operators cut themselves from a valuable opportunity. On the other hand, some operators argue that their customers would have wanted them to manage the experience and, on such a constrained device, avoid giving access to too many services.

So is WAP a complete failure? Countries that had been using cellular phones for a number of years such as Japan have fairly successful WAP applications. It has also led to the development of alternate systems such as i-mode. Korea is also leading the world in providing advanced WAP services. WAP on top of the CDMA2000 network has been proven to be the state of the art wireless data infrastructure.

From 2003/2004, WAP has made a stronger resurgence with the introduction of Wireless services. Transfer of GPRS and UMTS data, which is a different model to the Web, generates operator revenues and usage is up. People are starting to use